

Q1CY25, will house all its 17,000 Chennai employees, who are currently spread out across four offices. Says Venkatakrishnan Subramaniam, HR Head-Chennai at Standard Chartered GBS India: “Whether it is cash, trade, liability, asset, services, transactions, compliance, risk, technology, finance or HR, you name it and there’s a huge talent set available here,” he says, adding that the average size of their team units is 500-plus, and 130-140 senior-most leaders in the organisation are in Chennai. “I get a good confluence of people from across the country. That is why we have been able to scale up from around 370 employees at the start 20 years ago to 17,000 now.”

L&T Realty’s Joshi attributes the city’s educational prowess, skilled workforce and superior living standards as the reason MNCs are attracted to the city. A strong campus culture over the past two decades has ensured a regular supply of junior- and middle-management talent pools. In addition, Chennai also offers a more stable workforce where employee tenures are typically longer and attrition is lower. Subramaniam says the average tenure of their employees across experience bands is 5-6 years, which means they experience the entire product cycle and make room for experimentation. “Chennai is minimalistic and functional, unlike Bengaluru which benchmarks everything with Silicon Valley. They don’t expect too many add-ons, such as goodies, freebies and the whole shebang of infrastructure like big breakout areas, which employees in Bengaluru do,” says Das, adding that an HR professional’s job is simpler in Chennai.

Even a decade ago, it was common for professionals in Chennai to migrate to other cities or countries for career progression, but that’s not so much the case anymore. Now, the influx of many multinationals, a thriving start-up culture, and global players establishing their GCCs have ensured a higher quality of opportunities. For instance, GCCs of companies like Shell, Qualcomm, Hitachi Energy India, etc., have made significant commitments to Chennai’s office real estate market, with Dow Chemicals alone leasing a substantial 250,000 sq. ft space in Q3CY23.

Subramaniam says it was a challenge to attract talent to Chennai in the early part of their India journey. “But that has completely changed in the past 4-5 years. Now getting the right kind of talent from across the banking industry is no longer a difficulty.” Plus, the overall infrastructure development in the form of transportation within the city and connectivity to other parts of the country, expanded food choices, a diminished language barrier, healthcare and education

HOT DEALS IN 2023

DLF is developing a new 740,000 sq. ft integrated campus for Standard Chartered Global Business Services at its Downtown property in Taramani. It will be Standard Chartered’s largest campus globally

India’s largest private lender HDFC Bank leased 306,200 sq. ft in CommerZone IT Park in Porur

Wind turbine maker Vestas leased 250,000 sq. ft in ITP Ascendas - Phase I in Taramani

Hitachi Energy leased 230,000 sq. ft in Porur’s CommerZone for its largest Global Technology and Innovation Centre.

Comcast India Engineering Center (CIEC) leased 93,700 sq. ft in Chennai One - Phase 2

Murugappa Group firm Cholamandalam Finance leased 80,000 sq. ft in Guindy’s Tamarai Tech Park

Flexi-working space provider IndiQube leased 165,000 sq. ft in Guindy

NOTE THESE ARE SOME OF THE MAJOR DEALS FOR OFFICE SPACE IN CHENNAI **SOURCE** CBRE

